

Healing From Anti-Black Racism

Healing what racism damaged in you

4 psychology approaches · tips & resources — by EvaTalk

CONTENTS

Healing From Anti-Black Racism

1. Before you begin
2. The 4 approaches
3. Psychodynamic lens
4. CBT lens
5. Humanistic lens
6. Systemic lens
7. Tips & advice
8. Your workbook
9. Your 4-week plan

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Healing what racism damaged in you

Anti-Black racism leaves marks: hypervigilance, exhaustion, self-doubt, and sometimes internalized self-contempt. What you experience is real.

This guide helps you recognize these wounds, deconstruct what you may have internalized, and rebuild with pride.

Your intention

A situation of anti-Black racism that marked you (or what you may have internalized): _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

What anti-Black racism deposits in you

Being the target of constant racism creates hypervigilance and exhaustion, and can lead to internalizing the racist lie: coming to devalue your skin, your hair, your origins.

Understanding that all this comes from outside — not from you — is the start of rebuilding.

Example

From hearing her features were 'less beautiful', Aïcha came to believe it. Realizing it was an internalized racist lie freed her.

What I internalized

What negative message about being Black did you come to believe? Where does it come from?

It comes from outside

Write: 'This isn't a flaw in me, it's a racism that was passed to me.'

→ *Anti-Black racism comes from outside — it's not a flaw in me.*

The internalized thoughts

'I must do twice as much to be worth it', 'better not make waves', 'my color is a problem': these are internalized racist messages, not truths about you.

Spotting and challenging them restores your freedom to exist fully.

Example

Sure he had to 'shrink himself', Sami saw the thought was a learned survival strategy, not an obligation.

Thoughts journal

Note: an internalized thought · where it comes from · a fairer truth.

Reframe

Turn 'my color is a problem' into 'racism is the problem — not my color'.

→ *The problem is racism — not who I am.*

Reclaiming your pride

Your skin, your hair, your history, your culture aren't burdens to correct: they're sources of strength, beauty and heritage. Reclaiming them means allowing yourself to exist fully.

You have the right to be proud of who you are.

Example

By reconnecting with her family history and role models who looked like her, Léa regained a pride others had tried to take.

My sources of pride

Write 3 things tied to your identity/culture you're (or want to be) proud of.

My role models

Name 2 Black people/figures who inspire you — and what they teach you about yourself.

→ *My heritage is a strength — I have the right to be proud of it.*

Rebuilding & surrounding yourself

Concretely: surround yourself with role models and communities, create spaces where you can breathe, set limits with toxic people and places, and put down the load (a professional who understands racial experience helps a lot).

You don't have to carry this alone.

Example

By joining a space where she didn't have to 'explain everything', Fatou could finally rest — and heal.

My spaces to breathe

Where / with whom can you be yourself without justifying it? How to create more?

My limits

A limit to set with racism (you don't have to educate everyone): _____

→ *Surrounding myself and setting limits — that's how I rebuild.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Anti-Black racism comes from the system, not from you.
- Your hypervigilance and exhaustion are normal responses to real aggression.
- Spot and deconstruct internalized messages (beauty, worth, legitimacy).
- Reclaim pride and heritage (role models, culture, history).
- Surround yourself with spaces and people who feel good; set limits (you don't have to explain everything).
- Putting down this load with a professional who understands racial experience can help a lot.

To fill in

What I'm deconstructing

Internalized message	A fairer truth

What rebuilds me

Source of pride / role model	Space to breathe

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Recognize what anti-Black racism deposited in me.

Week 2 — Deconstruct an internalized thought.

Week 3 — Reclaim a source of pride.

Week 4 — Surround myself & set a limit.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The internalized message I let go:
- My source of pride:
- My space to breathe:

TO CLOSE

Anti-Black racism comes from outside — your pride is yours.

Anti-Black racism comes from outside — your pride is yours.

The racism, anti-Blackness and misogynoir you experience are real: this guide never minimizes them or asks you to adapt to the unacceptable. It's a coaching and psychoeducation tool to rebuild — not therapy. If you're going through a hard time, reach out to a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.